DESIGN CAPSULE · INDIA 2026–27

Design Capsule: Indian craft goes global

Kolhapuris on the Prada runway, mirror work, Rabari and kantha embroidery, block prints and bandhani.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



Mood and colour

Rust 18-1248 TPX #B5522B	Indigo 19-3864 TPX #2F3F7A
Champagne gold 14-0935 TPX #D8C08A	Ivory 11-0104 TPX #F3ECDC

Pantone TPX codes are the nearest match to the screen colour; confirm against a physical Pantone book and lab dips before production.

Why? The Kolhapuri debate made Indian shoppers proud of the original crafts. GI-tagged and artisan-made products now carry real brand value.

What? Indian crafts are in the global spotlight. Prada showed Kolhapuri-inspired sandals in 7 of 56 Spring/Summer 2026 looks, Rabari embroidery reached the Indian runway, and kantha is moving onto sneakers.

Who's showing it?

- **Prada (Spring/Summer 2026)**: Kolhapuri-inspired sandals in 7 of 56 looks
- **Kartik Research**: Rabari embroidery on handspun khadi
- **Gully Labs**: Sneakers with kantha embroidery and Indian colour stories

Key pieces

Forecut flat sketches with reference photos, ready to brief into design.





Kolhapuri chappals

RISING

GI-tagged Kolhapuris, back in focus after Prada's Spring/Summer 2026 show.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Rising	Peaking	Peaking



Mirror work

RISING

Mirror work on garments, dupattas, bags and shoes.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Rising	Peaking	Peaking



Rabari embroidery

EMERGING

Kutch Rabari embroidery, shown by Kartik Research.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Emerging	Rising	Rising



Kantha-embroidered sneakers

EMERGING

Suede sneakers with kantha embroidery.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Emerging	Rising	Rising

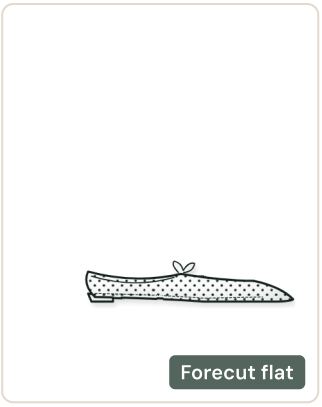


Bandhani

RISING

Tie-dye dots from Gujarat and Rajasthan.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Rising	Rising	Peaking





Embellished wedding juttis

PEAKING

Juttis with zari, beads and mirror work for weddings.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Price guide (India)

KEY GARMENT	VALUE	MID	PREMIUM
Kolhapuri chappals	₹499–1,299	₹1,500–3,500	₹6,000+
Mirror-work kurta or jacket	₹1,299–2,499	₹3,000–7,000	₹15,000+
Embroidered juttis	₹799–1,499	₹1,800–4,000	₹7,500+

Cost to make: Medium. Hand embroidery is labour-heavy. Use placement embroidery and partner with clusters for authentic GI-tagged pieces.

How to build the capsule

- Source one GI-tagged hero product and credit the craft cluster.
- Add mirror or kantha accents to everyday basics.
- Pair Kolhapuris and juttis with western looks in imagery.

Sources: Global Indian on Prada SS26; Free Press Journal, Lakmé Fashion Week 2026; Gully Labs.